

NITIN SAXENA

EDUCATION ENTREPRENEUR | ACADEMIC LEADER | CURRICULUM & LEARNING CONSULTANT

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23+ YEARS IN EDUCATION • FOUNDER & DIRECTOR • IISc Ph.D. • RESEARCH + CURRICULUM + STUDENT DEVELOPMENT

EXECUTIVE POSITIONING

Education entrepreneur and academic leader who has built a career at the intersection of teaching, institution building, research, curriculum development and student development. Founder & Director of Kriya Coaching Classes, with responsibility for academic operations, teaching, assessment, parent engagement, learner support and educational planning. Ph.D. in Ecology & Evolution from the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), complemented by experience in statistics, research methodology, phylogenetics and quantitative biology. Has worked across school education, coaching, higher education, alternative learning, research mentoring and community education.

LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIO

EDUCATION ENTREPRENEURSHIP	CURRICULUM & CONTENT	RESEARCH & ANALYTICS	STUDENT SUCCESS
Founder & Director of Kriya Coaching Classes; academic operations, planning, teaching systems, assessment and stakeholder engagement.	Curriculum architecture, textbook development, learning outcomes, worksheets, question banks and NIOS-aligned educational resources.	IISc Ph.D.; large biological datasets; statistics, biostatistics, R, phylogenetics, study design and research methodology.	Academic mentoring, career counselling, inclusive learning, parent-student conflict resolution and support for diverse learners.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Founder & Director | Kriya Coaching Classes, Bengaluru

c. 2021 – Present

- Built and lead an independent education centre in Yelahanka serving school and senior-secondary learners across CBSE, ICSE and NIOS pathways.
- Own the academic operating model: curriculum planning, batch structures, timetabling, assessments, worksheets, examination preparation, student progress and parent communication.
- Remain directly involved in teaching while setting academic standards, designing learning resources and shaping the student experience.
- Design competency-based tests, board-oriented papers, answer keys, remediation resources and differentiated learning plans across grades and subjects.
- Provide academic and career counselling and facilitate parent-student conflict-resolution discussions around expectations, learning needs and educational choices.
- Work with diverse learners, including students needing additional academic support and neurodivergent learners.

Academic Consultant – Curriculum & Textbook Development | Alternative Learning School, Bengaluru

Consulting / Project-based

- Designed curriculum and educational resources for an alternative-learning environment, aligning content with NIOS curriculum requirements.
- Developed textbook-style material, learning outcomes, activities, assessment structures and learner-support resources.

Assistant Professor – Microbiology / Biostatistics | St. Joseph's University, Bengaluru

2021 – 2022

- Taught biostatistics to postgraduate microbiology students, integrating quantitative reasoning, practical application and interpretation of scientific data.
- Conducted offline and online teaching and contributed to examination-paper preparation and evaluation; introduced practical exposure to R.

Independent Academic, Statistics & Research Consultant | Independent Practice

2017 – Present | Project-based

- Support Master's and Ph.D. researchers with research methodology, study design, statistical reasoning, data analysis, interpretation and thesis development.
- Provide academic mentoring in biostatistics, evolutionary biology, molecular genetics, bioinformatics, R and quantitative methods.

ACADEMIC CAREER & RESEARCH FOUNDATION

Project Assistant – Theoretical Ecology & Evolution | Centre for Ecological Sciences, IISc

Jan 2013 – Jul 2014

- Led an independent project on the evolution of collective movement in fish using a phylogenetic approach; worked on study design and analysis.
- Supervised two Master's dissertation projects and supported laboratory administration, academic coordination and lab meetings.

IISc RESEARCH SPOTLIGHT

Ph.D. research on the evolutionary history of migratory behaviour in birds, using large-scale data involving 10,000+ species and combining phylogenetics, animal behaviour, probability, inferential statistics and quantitative modelling.

EARLIER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

RCMS-AR Specialist & CSR Lead | Sutherland Healthcare Solutions

Aug 2014 – Jun 2015

- Worked with US healthcare processes, medical procedures, coding/modifiers, insurance claims and reimbursement workflows.
- Supported CSR initiatives and received internal recognition for social-impact work and training performance.

Primary & Secondary Teacher | India Overseas School, Jaipur

Jul 2012 – Dec 2012

- Taught Science and Mathematics for Grades 3–10 and English and Biology for Grades 11–12; designed Biology lesson plans and supported students requiring additional attention.

Teaching, Mentoring & Community Education | Schools, Coaching & Community Programmes

2003 onward

- Teaching since Grade 7; experience across home tutoring, coaching institutes, schools, colleges, universities and research settings.
- Volunteered with the Teach India campaign; taught underprivileged learners and conducted NEET Biology crash-course teaching.
- Mentored students and competitive-exam aspirants, including support for GATE, CSIR-UGC NET, UPSC, CAT and Bank PO preparation.

STUDENT DEVELOPMENT & LEARNER SUPPORT

- Career counselling and academic guidance focused on educational pathways, strengths, interests and decision-making.
- Peer support, grief support and mental-health volunteering; experience in peer counselling and student/family conversations.

- Parent–student conflict resolution within the coaching environment, with emphasis on communication, expectations and learning needs.
- Experience supporting underprivileged learners and neurodivergent learners, with an emphasis on respectful, individualised learning.

EDUCATION, CREDENTIALS & RECOGNITION

- Ph.D. in Ecology & Evolution — Centre for Ecological Sciences, Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru | 2015–2026.
- B.Tech. in Biotechnology — Jaipur National University, Jaipur | 2008–2012 | 72.36% aggregate.
- CSIR-JRF / UGC-NET, Life Sciences — All India Rank 77 | TIFR-GS qualified | GATE 2015, Ecology & Evolution — All India Rank 36.
- Selected recognition: Certificate of Appreciation for social-impact work; 'Dawn Star' recognition for training performance at Sutherland Healthcare Solutions.
- Mentored 30+ aspirants for competitive examinations/interviews over the documented period in the previous CV.

CORE EXPERTISE

Education Leadership • Academic Operations • Curriculum Architecture • Textbook Development • Instructional Design • Assessment & Examination Design • NIOS Alignment • Student Success • Career Counselling • Inclusive Learning • Research Methodology • Study Design • Statistics & Biostatistics • R Programming • Phylogenetics • Scientific Communication

TARGET LEADERSHIP & CONSULTING DOMAINS

Academic Leadership | Education Consulting | Curriculum & Learning Design | School/University Academic Administration | EdTech | Educational Publishing | Student Success | Academic Programme Design | Research & Quantitative Education